

SDG Goal 3

Good health and well-being

SDG Target 3.5

Strengthen the prevention and treatment of substance abuse, including narcotic drug abuse and harmful use of alcohol

SDG Indicator 3.5.2

Alcohol per capita consumption (aged 15 years and older) within a calendar year in litres of pure alcohol

Time series

Alcohol consumption

1. General information on the time series

- Date of national metadata: January 16, 2026
- National data: <http://sdg-indicators.de/3-5-2/>
- Definition: The time series shows per capita alcohol consumption (PKA) among the population aged 15 and over, expressed in liters of pure alcohol per person. Total consumption comprises the consumption of beer, sparkling wine, wine, intermediate products, spirits, and alcopops.

Beer

Beer consumption also includes beer provided free of charge to brewery employees. Non-alcoholic beer and malt beverages are excluded. An average alcohol content of 5%_{vol.} is assumed for alcohol consumption.

Sparkling wine

No data for sparkling wine is available in the sparkling wine and intermediate product tax statistics for the 2010 reporting year. For 2010, the average value from 2009 and 2011 is therefore used.

An average alcohol content of 12%_{vol.} is assumed for alcohol consumption.

Wine

Wines for distilleries and vinegar production are excluded from wine consumption. Consumption is recorded over the so-called wine year (August to July). The larger part of the wine year forms the basis for the corresponding reporting year: January 1 to July 31 (7 months) → wine year 2023/2024 corresponds to consumption for the year 2024. An average alcohol content of 12%_{vol.} is assumed for alcohol consumption.

Intermediate products

The intermediate product statistics distinguish between products with an average alcohol content of a) less than 15%_{vol.} and b) an average alcohol content of more than 15%_{vol.} As no more precise information on alcohol content is available, an alcohol content of 10%_{vol.} is assumed for a) and an alcohol content of 20%_{vol.} for b).

Spirits

For spirits, alcohol consumption is reported directly in the alcohol tax statistics.

Alcopops

The tax statistics do not contain any quantity data for alcopops, so the taxes paid must be calculated back to the quantity of alcohol consumed (€5550 per hl of pure alcohol).

Total alcohol consumption is adjusted for so-called unregistered consumption. Unregistered consumption refers to alcohol that is not taxed and falls outside the usual system of government control, such as home-brewed or informally produced alcohol (legal or illegal), smuggled alcohol, substitute alcohol (alcohol not intended for human consumption), or alcohol purchased across borders (which is recorded in another jurisdiction). The amount of unregistered alcohol consumed was determined in an international survey in 2021 and stands at 3.8% for Germany.

Alcohol consumption is further adjusted for the amount of alcohol consumed by German tourists abroad and the amount consumed by foreign tourists in Germany. These so-called tourism factors are estimated annually by the WHO. For Germany, the factor is usually slightly net positive (German tourists abroad consume more alcohol than foreign tourists in Germany).

- Disaggregation: age group

2. Comparability with the UN metadata

- Date of UN metadata: March 2023
- UN metadata: <https://unstats.un.org/sdgs/metadata/files/Metadata-03-05-02.pdf>
- The time series is compliant with the UN metadata.

3. Data description

- The data is calculated for reporting purposes by the German Center for Addiction Issues.

The data on beer, sparkling wine, spirits as well as intermediate products and so called alcopop consumption is taken from the excise duties statistics of the Federal Statistical Office, while the data on wine consumption is taken from the Federal Ministry of Agriculture, Food and Regional Identity (BMLEH). These data on wine consumption is based on the foreign trade statistics as well as the agricultural statistics on wine of the Federal Statistical Office of Germany.

The population data comes from the intercensal population updates, the basis of which is the last census conducted in 2022. The population data is rolled forward using statistical results on natural population change (births, deaths) and migrations.

4. Access to data source

- Alcohol per capita consumption (only available in German):
<https://osf.io/xkv4h/files/uwn65>
- Sales of beer, breweries in operation, consumption of beer – GENESIS online 73421-0001:

- <https://www-genesis.destatis.de/genesis//online?operation=table&code=73421-0001&bypass=true&language=en>
- Sales, consumption and producers of sparkling wine – GENESIS online 73423-0001:
<https://www-genesis.destatis.de/genesis//online?operation=table&code=73423-0001&bypass=true&language=en>
 - Distilleries, consumption of alcohol – GENESIS online 73441-0001:
<https://www-genesis.destatis.de/genesis//online?operation=table&code=73441-0001&bypass=true&language=en>
 - Revenue from taxes: Germany, years, types of taxes prior to distribution – GENESIS online 71211-0001:
<https://www-genesis.destatis.de/datenbank/online/table/71211-0001/search/s/NzEyMTFtMDAwMQ%3D%3D>
 - Statistical Yearbook (only available in German):
<https://www.bmel-statistik.de/archiv/statistisches-jahrbuch>
 - Average population – GENESIS online 12411-0041:
<https://www-genesis.destatis.de/genesis//online?operation=table&code=12411-0041&bypass=true&levelindex=1&levelid=1639396599054#abreadcrumb>

5. Metadata on source data

- Calculation of per capita alcohol consumption (PKA) – basis for reporting by the Deutschen Hauptstelle für Suchtfragen:
<https://osf.io/xkv4h/files/p83x9>
- Quality reports – Excise duties statistics (only available in German):
https://www.destatis.de/DE/Themen/Staat/Steuern/Verbrauchssteuern/_inhalt.html#sprg383062
- Quality report – Survey on beer tax / brewery industry (only available in German):
<https://www.destatis.de/DE/Methoden/Qualitaet/Qualitaetsberichte/Steuern/biersteuer.pdf?>
- Quality report – Sparkling wines tax and survey on provisional product tax (only available in German):
<https://www.destatis.de/DE/Methoden/Qualitaet/Qualitaetsberichte/Steuern/schauweinsteuer.pdf?>
- Quality Report – Intercensal population updates:
<https://www.destatis.de/EN/Methods/Quality/QualityReports/Population/einfuehrung.html>

6. Timeliness and frequency

- Timeliness: Beer: t + 13 months; Spirits: t + 4 months;
Sparkling wine and intermediate product: t + 5 months; Wine: t + max. 12 months
- Frequency: Annual

7. Calculation method

- Unit of measurement: Litres of pure alcohol per capita
- Calculation:

$$\text{APC} = \frac{\sum_i \text{Over } i \text{ used alcohol [l]}}{\text{Population 15 years and older [number]}} + \text{unrecorded consumption} + \text{tourist consumption}$$

with:

i = {beer; sparkling wine; wine; spirits; intermediate products; alcopops}

$$\text{unrecorded consumption} = \frac{\text{recorded consumption [l]} \cdot 3,8 [\%]}{100 - 3,8 [\%]}$$

tourist consumption = estimates by WHO